



ROLE OF TEACHERS IN OPERATIONALISING AND EVALUATING CURRICULUM

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5.1 INTRODUCTION

In the previous chapters, we explored what curriculum means, how it is designed, and the importance of inclusive, creative, and resource-rich learning environments. We also discussed the value of involving families and communities in the learning process. Building on this foundation, this chapter focuses on the role of teachers in operationalising and evaluating the curriculum, specifically, how teachers bring the curriculum to life using both print and non-print materials, and how they assess its effectiveness in the classroom. This chapter acts as a bridge to the next unit, which will delve deeper into the actual process of curriculum transaction, providing teachers practical tools and techniques for daily classroom implementation.

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Case Study:

It was a bright Monday morning in a small village school. Meena, a newly posted primary teacher, looked at her timetable—first period: mathematics. She glanced at the curriculum document that mentioned “Children will identify numbers up to 10 and count objects.” Meena smiled and opened her bag. Instead of textbooks alone, she pulled out colourful beads, number cards, and a few bottle caps for hands-on engagement. As the children gathered around, Meena sang a number rhyme and gave each child some beads to count. They laughed, touched, sorted, and counted with joy. At the end of the class, not only had they learned numbers, but they had also practiced sorting and cooperation.

That day, Meena went beyond reading the curriculum, but brought it to life. Meena turned curriculum goals into real classroom learning experiences using creative methods and available materials.

Similar to Meena’s approach in her classroom, we as foundational stage teachers must be skilled in both implementing and assessing the curriculum. Doing so guarantees that educational experiences are tailored to students’ developmental stages, maintain their interest, and foster genuine learning. By putting curriculum goals into practice through purposeful activities and appropriate resources, teachers can monitor student progress and adjust their instruction to support each child’s individual learning journey and needs. This process is essential for creating an effective and responsive educational environment



5.2 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After completion of this chapter, the learner:

- identifies various print and non-print resources for operationalising the curriculum in the foundational or preparatory stage;
- integrates print and non-print resources effectively to create engaging, multimodal classroom experiences that align with the initiatives of the Ministry of Education, Government of India;
- demonstrates the ability to select and adapt age-appropriate, inclusive, and culturally relevant teaching-learning materials to suit the needs of diverse learners;

- adapts curriculum materials by localising content and modifying for diverse learners in the multilingual context;
- reflects own practices and assesses the effectiveness of different resource materials in achieving intended curricular outcomes.

5.3 IMPORTANCE OF CURRICULUM IMPLEMENTATION IN FOUNDATIONAL EDUCATION

The foundational stage (ages 3-8)/preparatory stage (ages 8-11) is critical for lifelong learning. Effective curriculum implementation, as emphasised in NEP 2020 and NCF-FS 2022, ensures holistic development through play-based, competency-focused approaches. Teachers operationalise learning outcomes using diverse print (textbooks, flashcards) and non-print materials (like NCERT initiatives Jaadui Pitara, DIKSHA), creating inclusive, engaging environments that bridge theory with practice and foster active participation. By thoughtfully selecting, adapting, and evaluating these resources, educators translate policy into meaningful classroom experiences that nurture curiosity, foundational literacy/numeracy, and socio-emotional skills – laying the groundwork for all future learning.

5.4 MEANING OF OPERATIONALISING AND EVALUATING CURRICULUM

Operationalising the curriculum means putting the curriculum into action in the classroom. It involves planning lessons, selecting appropriate teaching-learning materials, designing activities, and using strategies that help achieve the intended learning outcomes. Teachers transform curriculum goals into real experiences that are meaningful and engaging for learners.

Evaluating the curriculum refers to the process of assessing how effectively the curriculum is being implemented and whether the learning objectives are being achieved. It includes monitoring student progress, reviewing teaching strategies, and reflecting on the use of materials and identifying areas for improvement. Evaluation helps in improving teaching practices and ensuring that the curriculum meets the learners' needs.

Let us now understand this concept with the following example: -

Example:

Suppose the curriculum objective is, “Children should develop early literacy



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skills, such as recognising letters and their sounds.”

Operationalising:

The teacher plans a series of interactive activities. She reads aloud from a colourful alphabet storybook (print material), sings alphabet songs, and sets up a ‘letter hunt’ in the classroom where children search for hidden letter cards. She also provides magnetic letters for children to arrange on boards, making letter shapes with playdough (non-print material), and encourages them to trace letters in sand traysto reinforce tactile learning.

Evaluating:

To assess progress, the teacher observes which children can identify and pronounce letters during activities, asks them to match objects to their beginning sounds, and keeps simple checklists or portfolios of each child’s work. She adapts lessons based on which letters or sounds children find challenging, ensuring every child is provided with the support they need.

This approach ensures the curriculum is not just a document, but a living, dynamic experience-carefully planned, enacted, and adjusted to meet each child’s developmental needs.

5.5 UNDERSTANDING CURRICULUM MATERIALS FOR FOUNDATIONAL STAGE

5.5.1 Print Materials

Print Materials form the core physical resources for early learning. They include physical, tangible educational resources used in foundational classrooms. Print materials are physical learning resources like textbooks, flashcards, workbooks, and story posters.

Textbooks and Workbooks

These are structured learning resources designed to develop core competencies. Textbooks present age-appropriate content, while workbooks provide practice exercises. They form the basic framework for lessons.

Teacher Handbooks and Guides

These are professional support materials that help educators implement curriculum. They contain teaching methodologies, activity plans, and assessment

tools. They are essential for effective classroom delivery.

Flashcards, Posters and Charts

Visual learning tools that simplify complex concepts through images. Flashcards build vocabulary and recognition, posters display key information, charts organise knowledge systematically in a visually accessible manner.

Supplementary Readers and Storybooks

Additional reading materials from the National Book Trust, Children's Book Trust (CBT) which enhance literacy and language skills. They expose children to diverse narratives, cultivate reading habits, and support holistic development.

5.5.2 Non-Print Materials

Non-print materials are interactive, multi-sensory learning resources that go beyond traditional textbooks. They include digital tools, tactile kits, audio content, and manipulatives which together create rich, engaging experiences for young learners. These materials blend traditional and innovative approaches, making learning more joyful, inclusive, and effective.

Digital Resources (DIKSHA, e-Pathshala)

Digital platforms like DIKSHA (Digital Infrastructure for Knowledge Sharing) and e-Pathshala offer interactive, curriculum-aligned content. DIKSHA provides competency-based e-modules, while e-Pathshala hosts digital textbooks. These platforms support personalised learning through animations, quizzes, and multimedia activities. Teachers use them to enrich classroom lessons and to efficiently track student progress digitally.

Audio-Visual Programs and e-Content

Multimedia resources such as educational videos, animated stories, and interactive games make abstract ideas tangible through visual and auditory stimulation. These tools are especially powerful for language development and introducing new concepts in an engaging way. By integrating audio-visual content, teachers can better engage diverse learners, transforming the classroom into a dynamic, inclusive space that supports both academic and personal growth.



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Educational Kits

- Educational kits are thoughtfully designed collections of story cards, puzzles, toys, and games that turn early learning into a playful, hands-on experience. Kits like Jaadui Pitara (NCERT) – A multilingual, play-based foundational kit) align with foundational competencies, promoting literacy, numeracy, motor development, creativity, and problem-solving. Teachers use these kits to set up interactive learning stations that encourage exploration and peer collaboration. A few examples are Balvatika kit, Read India Kit and toy-based pedagogy kit.

They help to:

- Spark curiosity and imagination
- Build key skills in literacy, numeracy, and motor development
- Foster social interaction, creativity, and problem-solving
- Support learning through play and storytelling

Manipulatives and Hands-on Learning Tools

These are tangible objects such as counting blocks, shape sorters, and measuring tools that children can handle and explore. They are essential for building fine motor skills and deepening understanding of mathematical concepts. Teachers select manipulatives based on developmental levels and lesson goals, making abstract ideas more concrete, and accessible.

Puppets and Role-Play Materials

Props like puppets and role-play kits (e.g., doctor sets, kitchen sets) encourage imagination, language development, and social-emotional learning. Puppets can model behaviours and new vocabulary, while role-play activities help children practice communication and life skills. Teachers often use them for storytelling and socio-dramatic play, creating interactive and meaningful learning moments.

Together, these non-print materials enrich the learning environment, supporting holistic development and making foundational education more engaging, relevant, and child-centered.

5.5.3 Integrating Print and Non-Print Materials: A Multimodal Approach

To address varied learning styles & contexts we should operationalise the curriculum by blending print and non-print materials. Print materials like books and worksheets support reading and writing, while non-print tools—such as audio stories, videos, and hands-on objects—enhance engagement and understanding. This multimodal approach ensures that learning is accessible, engaging, and aligned with both curriculum goals and student needs. It empowers us to create rich, inclusive, and dynamic learning environments where every child can thrive and develop a lifelong love for learning

Example 1: Theme – Seasons and Weather

- **Print Material:** The teacher displays a colourful chart showing the four seasons and distributes worksheets for children to match clothing or activities with the correct season.
- **Non-Print Material:** Children listen to weather sounds (like rain, thunder, wind), watch videos of seasonal changes, and dress dolls in season-appropriate clothes.
- **Outcome:** This supports auditory, visual, and tactile learning styles, making abstract concepts like weather relatable and concrete.

Example 2: Theme – Animals and Their Homes

- **Print Material:** The teacher uses a big book about animals and where they live, with large pictures and simple text.
- **Non-Print Material:** Children match toy animals to miniature homes (burrow, nest, cave), watch a short animation, and sing animal-themed songs.
- **Outcome:** Through storytelling, play, and visuals, children develop language, categorization, and observation skills in a joyful, integrated way.

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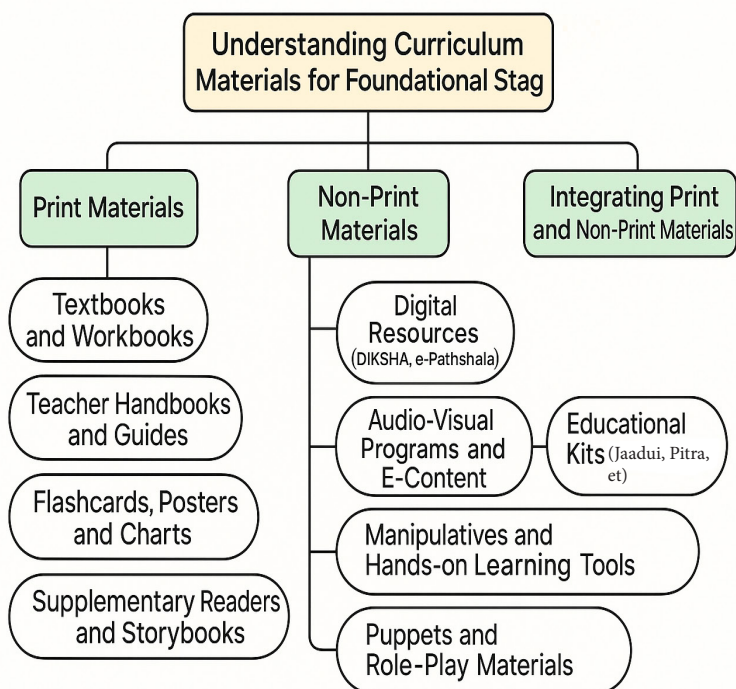


Fig. 5.1: Curriculum Materials for Foundational Education



CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 5.1

- How do print and non-print materials complement each other in enhancing learning experiences at the foundational stage? Illustrate with an example from your classroom.
- Which of the following is NOT considered a print material for the foundational stage?
 - Textbooks
 - Flashcards
 - DIKSHA e-Content
 - Story posters
- What is the main purpose of using educational kits like Jaadui Pitara in foundational classrooms?
 - To provide structured textbook learning
 - To promote hands-on, play-based, and interactive learning
 - To assess students only through written tests
 - To replace all digital resources

Answers : 2-c; 3-b

5.6 OPERATIONALISING THE CURRICULUM: THE TEACHER'S ROLE

Teachers are at the heart of bringing curriculum frameworks to life, turning them into rich, meaningful classroom experiences. This role is dynamic and multifaceted, demanding creativity, careful planning, and responsiveness to each child's unique needs.

5.6.1 Ensuring Alignment

NIPUN Bharat (National Initiative for Proficiency in Reading with Understanding and Numeracy) is a national mission that aims to ensure all children in India achieve foundational literacy and numeracy by the end of Grade 3, by 2026-27. As teachers, it is our responsibility to select and use materials that support the specific learning outcomes identified under this mission.

However, our role goes beyond just academics. We also foster holistic development — helping children grow in communication, problem-solving, socio-emotional, and life skills. In this way, the materials we use not only build foundational competencies but also nurture well-rounded individuals. The following criteria should be used for selection of material:

5.6.1.1 Age-Appropriateness

Selecting age-appropriate materials is essential to keep children engaged and ensure effective learning. Resources should match students' cognitive, social, and emotional development. For example, in early primary classes, teachers might use colourful picture books, simple puzzles, and hands-on learning tools, while for older students, teachers might introduce more detailed stories, structured games, or basic research projects. Regularly reviewing and updating materials helps ensure they continue to meet children's evolving needs, preventing both frustration and boredom.

5.6.1.2 Inclusivity

Inclusive classrooms use materials that address the diverse backgrounds, abilities, and learning styles of all students. This means choosing resources that reflect different cultures, languages, and experiences so every child feels seen and valued, including bilingual storybooks, tactile aids for visually impaired students, and audio resources for varied learning needs and avoiding stereotypes and promoting fairness and respect. By doing so, teachers create an environment where every child can actively participate and succeed.

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5.6.1.3 Cultural Relevance

Culturally relevant materials connect learning to students' real lives and community backgrounds. This might include storybooks and folk tales from local traditions; math examples using familiar objects from home or the market; Science lessons that draw on traditional ecological knowledge.

Integrating culturally relevant materials not only makes learning more relatable but also fosters pride and respect for students' identities. Teachers can also invite community members to share stories or organize projects exploring local heritage. This approach not only makes learning more relatable but also builds pride in students' identities and strengthens ties between the classroom and community.

By thoughtfully selecting age-appropriate, inclusive, and culturally relevant materials, teachers operationalise the curriculum in ways that are engaging, equitable, and meaningful for every learner.

5.6.2 Material Adaptation

At the Foundational Stage (ages 3–8) and preparatory stage (age 8-11), the curriculum emphasises play-based, activity-oriented, and experiential learning, as outlined in the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and the National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage (NCF-FS, 2022) and NCFSE, 2023. For this vision to be implemented effectively, teachers play a pivotal role in adapting and contextualising learning materials to meet the diverse needs of young learners.

Material adaptation is a dynamic process. Curriculum goals are translated into meaningful, accessible, and engaging classroom experiences. In this, teacher modifies, enhances, or contextualize existing teaching learning materials to suit: the levels of learners, Classroom Environment, Individual learning needs and Interests, etc.

5.6.2.1 Localising Content for Diverse Classrooms

Children learn best when class materials/content reflect their lived experience. Therefore, we should modify stories, songs, and classroom topics to reflect local traditions, surroundings, festivals, the roles of community helpers, and everyday experiences from the children's lives. Transforming generic examples into culturally relevant contexts and this contextualization boosts engagement and comprehension

Examples: -

- **Language lessons use local animals:** For a child living in India, instead of reading about polar bears or penguins, children learn rhymes and stories featuring peacocks, cows, or goats commonly seen in their village.
- **Environmental studies focus on local surroundings:** When teaching about water bodies, the teacher discusses the nearby river or pond, encouraging children to share their own experiences of visiting or playing there.
- **Cultural references in art activities:** During drawing sessions, students are encouraged to create rangoli patterns or paint scenes from local fairs and festivals, such as Makar Sankranti or Holi.
- **Role-play with familiar occupations:** Dramatic play centers around roles like the village postman, milk vendor, or farmer, rather than less familiar professions depicted in textbooks.
- **Mathematics with local currency:** Instead of generic coins, teachers use real or replica rupees and paise, and set up a mock village market where children practice buying and selling vegetables.
- **Science lessons with local plants:** While learning about plants, children examine leaves and flowers from trees found around their school, such as neem or banyan, rather than exotic species.
- **Stories set in the local context:** Storytime features tales about children from the same region, using local names and settings, making the narratives more relatable.
- **Music and movement with regional songs:** Teachers incorporate folk songs and traditional dances from the area, connecting music lessons to the children's cultural heritage.

5.6.2.2 Modifying Materials for Different Learning Needs

We must customise resources for varied learning styles and abilities. For dyslexic students, teachers provide yellow-tinted reading sheets with wider spacing. Kinaesthetic learners receive number cards they can trace with fingers in sand trays. Visual schedules with picture symbols help autistic children follow routines. Advanced readers get “challenge cards” with extension questions.

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Storybooks are adapted with tactile elements for visually impaired learners. Such modifications ensure equitable access to learning.

Example:

Consider a class 1 student named Aanya, who finds it difficult to recognize letters and form words as quickly as her classmates. To support Aanya's learning, her teacher provides her with alphabet cards and picture books that match her current skill level, instead of only using the standard Grade 1 textbooks. During classroom activities, Aanya is encouraged to use letter tiles and tracing sheets, allowing her to learn through touch and movement. When it's time for assessments, the teacher asks her questions aloud and lets her respond by pointing to pictures or saying the answers, rather than writing them down. These adjustments help Aanya actively take part in lessons and demonstrate her understanding in a way that suits her learning needs. By making these changes, the teacher ensures that Aanya feels included and confident, creating a nurturing and equitable classroom environment for all learners.

5.6.2.3 Creating Multilingual Resources

Teachers play a vital role in making sure every child feels seen and understood, especially in classrooms where many languages are spoken. To help all students learn and grow, educators innovate with the materials they use.

In a Tamil Nadu classroom, for example, science vocabulary is written in both Tamil and English, so children can connect new ideas to words they already know. In Punjab, teachers record nursery rhymes in Punjabi and Hindi, letting children sing along in the language they're most comfortable with. In some schools along the Konkan coast, word walls proudly display the names of vegetables in Konkani, Marathi, and English, helping everyone expand their vocabulary together.

Teachers also build "language ladders," where common phrases are shown in several local dialects, making it easier for children to see connections between languages. For students who are still learning to read, picture-based instruction sheets help them follow along without needing to rely on text alone.

These thoughtful adaptations celebrate the rich tapestry of languages in our classrooms and help children develop new language skills with confidence. Whether it's customising worksheets and flashcards or creating audio recordings and digital content, teachers are always finding ways to make lessons meaningful



and accessible. Through their dedication, abstract ideas become clear and every child gets the chance to participate and succeed in demonstrating how powerful and transformative a teacher's touch can be in the foundational years of learning.

Example:

In a bustling classroom in Assam, the teacher knows her students come from homes where Assamese, Bengali, and Hindi are spoken. Wanting every child to feel at home in her classroom, she introduces a “days of the week” chart. Each day is written in Assamese, Bengali, and Hindi, with cheerful illustrations for each one-like a sun for Sunday or a book for Monday.

During morning circle time, the teacher invites students to say the day in whichever language they prefer, and together, the class repeats it in all three languages. Sometimes, children share stories about how their families celebrate special days, using words from their mother tongues. This daily routine helps students recognise similarities and differences between languages, gently expanding their vocabulary and boosting their confidence to speak up.

By weaving multiple languages into everyday routines and using colourful visual aids, the teacher creates a warm, inclusive environment. Every child sees their language valued and learns to appreciate others, making the classroom a true reflection of their community's rich diversity.

5.6.3 Effective Implementation :

5.6.3.1 Integrating Print & Non-Print Materials

As you have already read in the section 4.3, effective classroom instruction in foundational and preparatory stage requires thoughtful integration of both print and non-print materials. Print materials include storybooks, flashcards, alphabet charts, and worksheets, while non-print resources may include puppets, real objects, audio recordings, and digital media. For instance, while teaching a story, the teacher can read aloud from a big book (print), use puppets to act out characters (non-print), and show a short animation (digital non-print). This variety keeps children engaged and caters to auditory, visual, and kinesthetic learners. Teachers combine traditional and digital resources for holistic learning.

Example: While teaching ‘animal habitats’, a teacher should:

- use textbook diagrams (print) along with DIKSHA's interactive videos (non-print)



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- Supplement with Jaadui Pitara animal puzzles and flashcards
- Play animal sound clips during storybook reading. This multimodal approach caters to visual, auditory and kinaesthetic learners.

5.6.3.2 Balancing Structured & Play-Based Activities

As teachers of young children, it's important to create a classroom environment where both structure and imagination co-exist. While structured activities like guided reading or phonics lessons help children build essential skills, open-ended, play-based experiences allow them to explore, create, and learn in their own unique ways.

For instance, after practicing letter recognition with flashcards, you might transform a corner of your classroom into a lively "Post Office." Here, children can write simple notes or draw pictures, slip them into envelopes, and "mail" them in a homemade post-box. This playful setup lets students use their new literacy skills in an authentic context, making learning meaningful and memorable.

When it comes to numbers, you can weave variety throughout the day. Start with a structured activity like tracing numbers 1 to 10 on worksheets, helping children get comfortable with number shapes. Then, move outdoors for a play-based game of hopscotch, where kids shout out each number as they hop along the path. Later, set up a semi-structured role-play by creating a pretend grocery store. Children can use play money to "buy" and "sell" items, practicing counting and recognizing numbers, as they interact with friends.

By thoughtfully alternating between guided instruction and open-ended play, every child gets the chance to grow academically and develop confidence, creativity, and social skills. This balanced rhythm keeps learning fresh, joyful, and deeply engaging for every learner.

5.6.3.3 Multi-Level Teaching with Materials

Every child in a foundational classroom brings their own strengths and learning pace. As teachers, it's our job to make sure everyone feels included and challenged, regardless of where they are on their learning journey.

Multi-level teaching with materials refers to a teaching approach where students of different learning levels, ages, or abilities are taught together in the same classroom, using adapted materials that meet their varied needs.

Example:

Even a simple picture storybook can be used in many ways to suit different skill levels:

- For beginners, you might ask them to point out and name the characters or colours they see.
- Children who are a bit more advanced could be encouraged to put the story events in order using picture cards.
- Those who are ready for a challenge can imagine and share what might happen next or come up with their own endings to the story.

To make this easier, you can prepare question cards or activity prompts at different levels, so you're always ready to guide each child at their point of need.

By thoughtfully adapting your resources and activities, you create a classroom where every child feels valued and has the chance to shine-making learning both fair and joyful for all

CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 5.2

1. Why is it important to consider age-appropriateness, inclusivity, and cultural relevance when selecting learning materials? How do these factors support the effective implementation of the curriculum?
2. Describe two strategies teachers can use to make classroom materials more inclusive and culturally relevant for young learners.
3. Which of the following best represents the role of a teacher in material adaptation at the foundational stage?
 - a. Delivering content strictly as per the textbook
 - b. Selecting only print-based resources
 - c. Modifying and contextualising resources to meet learners' needs
 - d. Avoiding cultural references in teaching materials.

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4. Which of the following best demonstrates age-appropriate material selection for foundational stage learners?
 - a. Assigning complex science research papers
 - b. Using animated videos to teach counting in kindergarten
 - c. Giving lengthy historical novels to young children
 - d. Requiring advanced algebra problems in class 1

Answer : 3 - c; 4 - d

5.7 EVALUATING CURRICULUM EFFECTIVENESS

As foundational stage teachers, we all want to know: Are our materials and activities truly helping children learn, explore, and grow? Evaluating curriculum effectiveness is about more than just ticking boxes—it's about closely watching how children engage with their environment daily. By paying attention to what captures their interest, how they use different materials, and where they might need more support, we can adjust our teaching to better serve each child.

In this section, we explore practical ways to do this: monitoring material usage, using classroom observation techniques, and maintaining simple logs. Together, these strategies help ensure that our classrooms remain vibrant, responsive, and aligned with the learning needs of every learner.

5.7.1 Monitoring Material usage

Imagine your classroom buzzing with activity—some children gathered around a colourful art table filled with crayons and paper, while others explore a cozy reading nook. Yet, you might notice that the science corner, stocked with experiment kits, sits mostly unused. These simple observations give you powerful clues: perhaps the science kits need a more inviting introduction, or maybe new hands-on activities would spark interest.

By noticing which areas children naturally show interest in and which they tend to ignore, teachers can thoughtfully adapt the classroom environment. Monitoring how materials are used helps us evaluate whether the curriculum is being implemented effectively and remains engaging and developmentally appropriate.

5.7.2 Classroom Observation Techniques

Classroom observation is one of the most effective techniques for evaluating the impact of our materials and activities. Teachers can keep anecdotal notes, checklists, or running records to document how children interact with different resources. For instance, during a science lesson, some children might eagerly refer to wall charts, while others prefer exploring real leaves and flowers.

These observations reveal not just what children are learning, but how they are learning, enabling teachers to adjust support or introduce new materials as needed. Observational checklists help track these patterns, noting which resources are used most often and how students respond. These real-time insights allow teachers to adjust their teaching strategies, ensuring that materials are effectively helping students achieve learning goals.

5.7.3 Maintaining Material Usage Logs

Keeping simple usage logs helps teachers track how often and for what purpose materials are used. These might include the date, type of material (print or non-print), a brief activity description, and notes on student response. For example, you might record that the “number puzzle” was, class favourite this week, while a digital story captured interest for only a short time.

Over time, reviewing these logs reveals valuable trends: perhaps storybooks are always in demand, or certain activities only appeal to a few. This insight helps teachers make thoughtful decisions about what to keep, adapt, or replace, ensuring the classroom stays lively and effective for every learner. Regular observation, careful monitoring, and simple record-keeping allow teachers to continually refine their use of classroom materials—supporting both learner growth and curriculum goals in meaningful ways.

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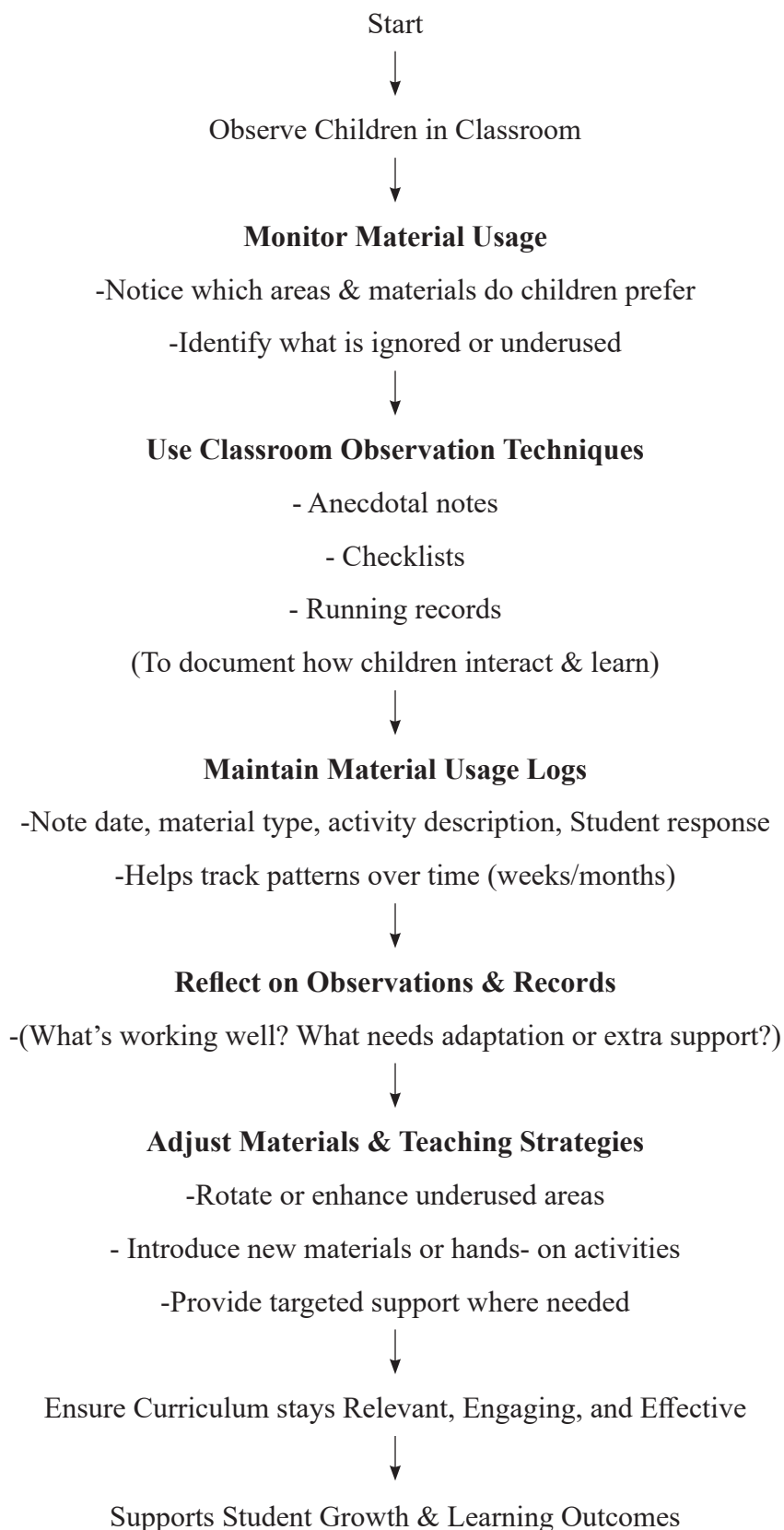
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Flowchart: Evaluating Curriculum Effectiveness





CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 5.3

1. How can maintaining a material usage log benefit both teachers and students in the long run?
2. How can classroom observation techniques help in evaluating the curriculum's effectiveness?
3. What should a material usage log typically include?
 - a. Only the names of students
 - b. The date, type of material, activity description, and student response
 - c. The teacher's favourite materials
 - d. The number of classroom decorations

Answers : 3-b

5.8 ASSESSING LEARNING OUTCOMES

Using rubrics, hands-on projects, and digital data equips teachers with powerful strategies for assessment, enabling them to be more responsive, reflective, and child-centered. Together these strategies create a dynamic and supportive learning environment, enriching teaching learning process and improving learning outcomes for every child.

5.8.1 Developing Rubrics for Assessment

Developing and using rubrics in foundational and preparatory classrooms helps teachers meaningfully assess children's learning across cognitive, language, social, and creative domains. Rubrics are structured assessment tools to evaluate student work against specific criteria and levels of performance. It helps teachers systematically evaluate how well children learn through different classroom materials and activities.

Using rubrics ensures assessment is more objective, fair, consistent and aligned with learning goals. It provides detailed insights into each child's progress and helps teachers adjust teaching methods and materials for improved outcomes

At the foundational and preparatory stages, rubrics typically include criteria such as:

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- **Engagement:** How interested and involved the child is with the material.
- **Understanding:** Whether the child grasps key concepts or processes.
- **Imagination and Creativity:** How the child explores ideas or creates something new.
- **Application:** How well the child uses what they've learned in new situations.
- **Communication:** How clearly the child expresses observations, thoughts, or answers.

Teachers can customise and create specific rubrics to assess:

- Skill development through use of various materials (like building blocks, picture books, math kits).
- Levels of engagement with different learning resources.
- Progress toward achieving foundational and preparatory stagecurricular competencies.

Example: Nature Walk Observation Activity

Materials Used: Magnifying glasses, Drawing sheets and colours

Rubric Criteria:

Aspect	What to Look For
Observation skills	Notices detail in leaves, insects, flowers, stones.
Ability to describe findings	Uses simple words or drawings to show findings.
Participation in group sharing	Talks about what was seen, listens to peers.

Rating Scale:

- 1 to 4 smiley faces, based on how actively and thoughtfully the child engages.

Additional Notes:

- Record which materials the child preferred (e.g. spent more time using magnifying glass, enjoyed drawing most, was excited about discussing findings).

5.8.2 Tracking Progress Through Activities and Projects

Teachers can assess the effectiveness of the curriculum by systematically tracking student progress over time through thematic activities and project work. Giving children opportunities to work with their hands and create small projects allows teachers to see how deeply they connect with what they are learning.

A practical way to document this growth is by maintaining simple portfolios or progress charts for each child. For example, in a “My Family” project, children might:

- **Draw pictures** of their family members (using print materials),
- **Talk about each person** during group discussions (practicing speaking and listening skills), and
- **Create a photo collage** (using non-print materials).

Such activities reveal growth in areas like language development, emotional expression, and fine motor skills. By collecting and revisiting these varied pieces of work, teachers gain a holistic view of each child’s learning journey and can reflect on how well the curriculum is supporting their needs.

Teachers can keep progress folders that showcase samples of the child’s work, capturing improvements in fine motor skills, vocabulary, creativity, and conceptual understanding.

5.8.3 Using Digital Analytics (DIKSHA Reports)

Digital platforms like DIKSHA are transforming classrooms by providing teachers with powerful tools to monitor and support each child’s learning journey. These platforms offer detailed analytics that help evaluate curriculum implementation and learning outcomes.

For instance, if DIKSHA reports show that children are enthusiastically completing story-based modules but are less engaged with math content, the teacher can adjust by introducing more hands-on math games or linking math to real-life contexts. Rather than just offering numbers, these analytics reveal patterns and insights that guide teachers in celebrating strengths and addressing areas needing reinforcement.

Teachers can track metrics such as:





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- Completion of assigned content,
- Time spent on learning modules,
- Quiz scores, and
- Participation in interactive activities.

For example, after assigning a digital story on DIKSHA, a teacher can review how many children watched it, attempted the questions, and how well they performed. These insights enable teachers to tailor instruction more effectively, ensuring every child receives the necessary support and encouragement.



CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 5.4

1. How can teachers use classroom observations and DIKSHA reports together to improve teaching strategies?
2. What is one advantage of tracking student progress through portfolios or project work?
 - a. It only shows test scores
 - b. It gives a holistic picture of a child's growth over time
 - c. It replaces the need for classroom observation
 - d. It is only useful for art activities
3. Which of the following is NOT a benefit of using rubrics for assessment?
 - a. They provide clear criteria for evaluation
 - b. They help teachers give consistent feedback
 - c. They make assessment more subjective and random
 - d. They guide teachers in refining instructional methods

Answers : 2-b; 3-c

5.9 CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

Continuous improvement in education means teachers constantly look for ways to make learning better for their students.

5.9.1 Gathering Feedback from Students and Peers

Improving teaching starts with being open to feedback. Even the youngest

learners have opinions—they can show what they liked, what confused them, or what they found exciting, often through a smile, a drawing, or a simple gesture. Asking them how they felt about an activity helps teachers see learning from their perspective.

Similarly, fellow teachers can offer valuable insights. A colleague observing your class might suggest small changes that make a big difference, like placing materials within easier reach or adding more hands-on activities.

By welcoming feedback from both children and peers, teachers can refine their strategies and materials, making learning more meaningful, engaging, and inclusive. Thus, continuous improvement in curriculum implementation involves regularly collecting feedback from students and peers.

5.9.2 Action Research for Material Enhancement

Action research lets teachers explore what works best in their classroom through structured experiments and reflection. Following are the steps of Action Research

Table 5.2: - Steps of Action Research for Material Enhancement

Step	Description
Identify the Problem	Observe the classroom to spot a challenge, e.g., low engagement with a material
Plan a Strategy	Decide on a change or introduce a new material. Set clear goals and define what success looks like.
Implement the Change	Try out the new material or strategy. Ensure it fits naturally within classroom activities.
Collect Data	Observe and record children's responses (reactions, engagement, and learning). Use tools like notes, checklists, or photos.
Analyse the Results	Reflect on what went well and what didn't. Compare new observations with earlier ones to assess impact.
Make Adjustments	Based on the findings, modify the approach to better support learning.
Document and share	Record your experience and outcomes. Share what worked with colleagues to build a library of best practices within the institution.



**Example:**

If a teacher notices low participation in storytelling with flashcards, they might switch to puppets and compare outcomes. This helps identify what better supports learning, leading to practical curriculum improvements. This small-scale, classroom-based research leads to meaningful enhancements in curriculum implementation

5.9.3 Documenting Best Practices and Reflecting on Teaching

Regularly reflecting on and documenting classroom experiences strengthens teaching. By noting how children respond to different materials—textbooks, handbooks, kits like Jaadui Pitara, or platforms like DIKSHA—teachers see what truly works in their specific contexts.

Documenting best practices not only helps teachers refine their own strategies but also allows them to share successful ideas with colleagues, building a supportive teaching community. This cycle of reflection, research, and sharing ensures that classrooms remain dynamic, responsive, and focused on every child's growth.

Keeping track of what works well in the classroom is a great way for teachers to grow professionally and facilitate curriculum improvement. By creating simple portfolios or jotting down reflections in a journal, teachers can capture moments when a particular lesson or material really connects with children.

Example:

If using a local folk tale with puppets leads to high engagement and better vocabulary recall, the teacher can note this with photos and share it in staff meetings, workshops or teacher training sessions. Over time, such documentation builds a resource pool of ideas that benefits all.

It can be concluded that by gathering feedback, experimenting thoughtfully, and documenting successes, teachers can ensure classrooms stay dynamic, responsive, and focused on every child's growth.

**CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 5.5**

1. How can action research help you improve your teaching materials and strategies?



2. Which of the following is a key benefit of documenting best practices in the classroom?
- It helps teachers remember what worked well and share successful strategies with others
 - It increases paperwork without improving teaching
 - It is only useful for school administrators
 - It replaces the need for feedback from students

Answers : 2-a

5.10 CHALLENGES AND SOLUTIONS

Despite having well-defined curriculum frameworks and guidelines, teachers often encounter practical challenges when implementing the curriculum in classrooms and evaluating its effectiveness—especially while using a mix of print and non-print materials.

The following table highlights some of these common challenges along with practical, classroom-friendly solutions to address them, ensuring that curriculum delivery and assessment remain meaningful, inclusive, and responsive to children's needs

Table 5.3: Common Implementation Challenges and Practical Solutions for Foundational and preparatory Stage Teachers

Challenge Area	Key Issues	Practical Solutions / Adaptations
Common Implementation Challenges	- Not enough materials for each child - Managing large groups with limited resources - Lack of training on how to use storybooks, flashcards, or digital tools - Noise and overcrowding in classrooms	- Use group activities to share materials - Establish classroom routines to manage large groups - Provide short demonstrations on using TLM - Use songs or signals to manage noise levels

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Resource Limitations in Rural Areas	- Few age-appropriate print/non-print materials - Insufficient textbooks/ workbooks - Lack of funds for kits - Poor availability of supplementary readers	- Make teaching aids from local materials (stones, cloth puppets) - Collect recyclable items (newspapers, bottle caps) - Build shared resource corners - Involve the community in creating or donating materials
Digital Divide & Technology Access	- Lack of mobile phones, tablets, or smart boards - Unreliable internet or electricity - Teachers or students may not be digitally literate	- Use downloaded content (DIKSHA modules) for offline use - Organize group learning with one device - Create WhatsApp learning groups - Pair children for buddy tech learning
Time Constraints for Material Preparation	- Heavy teaching loads - Little time to make or organize materials - Administrative duties take up planning time	- Fix a weekly slot for material prep - Rotate and reuse charts, flashcards, kits - Involve children in making or organizing materials - Co-create resources with colleagues - Use ready-made NCERT/ DIKSHA/ SCERT resources

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Evaluation of Curriculum Effectiveness	- Lack of simple tools to track material use and child progress - Teachers not confident using observation records or rubrics - Limited time to analyze and reflect	- Provide easy-to-use checklists, anecdotal record formats, rubrics - Short workshops on maintaining portfolios and using observations - Hold monthly review discussions to adjust plans
For continuous improvement feedback & Action Research related challenges	- Young children may not express feedback clearly - Hesitance to invite peer observations - Teachers unsure how to plan or document action research - Little time to keep journals or share best practices	- Use smiley charts, simple questions, watch body language - Friendly, informal peer visits - Try small experiments (e.g., switch flashcards to puppets) - Quick photo notes or sticky reflections - Share examples in meetings or WhatsApp groups
Continuous Professional Development (CPD) for teachers	- Limited access to training, especially in rural areas - Few chances to learn about new TLM, assessment tools, or digital platforms - No regular peer-sharing	- Use cluster/block meetings for peer-led demos - Create virtual sharing groups (WhatsApp) for ideas and resources - Plan micro-trainings on DIKSHA, SCERT modules, simple assessments - Recognize teachers who innovate to motivate others



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**CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 5.6**

1. How can foundational stage teachers effectively manage large groups of students when there are limited learning materials available?
2. What is one practical way to prepare teaching materials when teachers have limited time?
 - a. Avoid using materials altogether
 - b. Only rely on textbooks
 - c. Set aside a weekly time for material preparation
 - d. Skip other duties to make materials
3. Have you ever reused or repurposed a simple item to support classroom learning? What was the result?

Answers : 2-c

**5.11 LET US SUM UP**

The key points discussed in this chapter are as follows:

- **Teachers are the heart of the Classroom:** They turn curriculum goals into real, engaging learning experiences for children every day.
- **Foundation for Lifelong Learning:** The foundational stage (ages 3–8) focuses on holistic development through play-based and competency-driven learning, as per NEP 2020 and NCF-FS 2022.
- **Operationalising Curriculum:** Teacher's plan, choose materials, and create activities to achieve learning outcomes.
- **Curriculum Evaluation:** Continuous assessment through observation, checklists, and student work helps refine teaching strategies.
- **Value of Print Materials:** Books, workbooks, storybooks, flashcards, and teacher guides offer structure and rich language opportunities in the classroom.

- **Power of Non-Print Materials:** Digital resources like DIKSHA and e-Pathshala, hands-on kits like JaaduiPitara, audio-visual aids, and playful tools like puppets and manipulatives make learning dynamic and fun.
- **Blended Approach:** Combining print and non-print materials supports all learning styles—visual, auditory, kinesthetic—for inclusive education.
- **Teacher as Facilitator & Evaluator:** Teacher’s design, deliver, and improve learning experiences, ensuring every child progresses meaningfully.
- **Teachers are central** to implementing the curriculum meaningfully, aligning with NEP 2020 and NIPUN Bharat goals.
- **Material selection** must be:
 - Age-appropriate – matching developmental levels and interests.
 - Inclusive – catering to diverse needs, abilities, and backgrounds.
 - Culturally relevant – reflecting students’ local contexts and traditions.
- **Material adaptation** ensures access and engagement by:
 - Localising content to connect with students’ real-life experiences.
 - Modifying resources for varied learning needs and styles.
 - Promoting multilingual learning using home and regional languages.
- **Effective implementation** requires:
 - Integrating print and non-print materials like storybooks, videos, DIKSHA content, JaaduiPitara, etc.
 - Balancing structured and play-based activities for skill development and creativity.
 - Using multi-level teaching strategies to address learners at different proficiency levels.





Notes

- **Curriculum evaluation** involves:
 - Monitoring material usage through classroom observations and logs.
 - Using rubrics to assess learning outcomes based on engagement, comprehension, and application.
 - Tracking progress through thematic activities, projects, and portfolios.
- **Teachers must reflect, adapt, and innovate continuously** to ensure curriculum effectiveness and inclusive, joyful learning for all.

**5.12 END EXERCISES**

1. Describe how a teacher can effectively integrate both print and non-print materials to create a multimodal learning experience in the foundational stage. Give concrete examples of how this approach supports different types of learners.
2. Explain the process of adapting curriculum materials for a diverse classroom. Include at least two strategies for localizing content and two ways to address different learning needs.
3. Discuss the importance of evaluating curriculum effectiveness. What tools and techniques can teachers use to monitor material usage and assess whether learning outcomes are being met?
4. Think of a time when a classroom activity did not engage all students equally. What changes would you make to the materials or approach, based on what you have learned in this chapter?
5. Why is it important for teachers to document best practices and share them with colleagues? Describe how this habit can improve teaching and learning across a school community.
6. As a teacher, how can sharing your best classroom strategies and successes with colleagues benefit your school community? Give an example of a practice you would share and why.
7. List three common challenges teachers may face when implementing

curriculum materials in resource-limited settings. For each challenge, suggest a practical solution or adaptation.

8. How can gathering feedback from both students and peers contribute to continuous improvement in your teaching practice? Give examples of feedback methods suitable for young children.

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